

Module 03: Perception — Super Senses

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Perception** is how your brain feels the world.
2. Learn about the **5 Senses** (Sight, Sound, Smell, Taste, Touch).
3. Discover the **Secret Senses** (Body Position and Inside Feelings).

Introduction: The Robot Suit

Imagine you are in a giant robot suit. How do you know what is outside?

- Cameras (Eyes).
- Microphones (Ears).
- Sensors (Skin). Your body is the robot suit for your brain! Without senses, your brain would be in the dark.

Key Concepts

1. The Big Five (Outside Senses)

These tell you about the world.

- **Eyes:** "There is a wall!"
- **Ears:** "The dog is barking!"
- **Nose:** "Cookies are baking!" Babies use their MOUTH as a major sense to explore texture.

2. Proprioception (Body Sense)

Close your eyes. Touch your nose. How did you do that? You have sensors in your muscles that tell your brain where your arms are. Babies are still calibrating this (that's why they are clumsy!).

3. Interoception (Inside Sense)

How do you know you are hungry? Your stomach sends a text message to your brain.

- "Empty! Fill me!"
- "Full! Stop!" Listening to inside feelings helps us stay healthy.

Activities

Activity 1: The Blindfold Walk

Put a soft blindfold on. Have a partner guide you across the room. "Step up." "Turn left." Notice how much you rely on your eyes. Notice how much your FEET can feel the floor.

Activity 2: The Taste Test

Close your eyes and hold your nose. Eat a piece of apple, then a piece of potato. Can you tell the difference? Flavor is mostly smell! This is a fun trick to play on Dad.

Summary

Your senses are the windows to the world. By paying attention to what we see, hear, and feel, we gather the best data for our brains.

References

- *My Five Senses* by Alik
- *The Listening Walk* by Paul Showers